

THE POWER RANGER

Known as one of the brightest minds in the industry, Power Grid CMD K. Sreekant has earned the admiration of both colleagues and shareholders

By **Prerna Lidhoo**



A FAIR BOSS K. Sreekant, Chairman & MD, Power Grid

► **WHEN K. SREEKANT** was appointed the Chairman and Managing Director of Power Grid Corporation of India in August 2019, one of the first things he changed was the setting of his seventh-floor office in Gurugram. He had the pale, brown wall opposite his desk replaced with large French-style windows that showed off the building's vertical garden and the city's distant skyline. The view serves as a metaphor for Sreekant's leadership skills: open, positive and practical.

For Sreekant, it's all about fairness and merit. "I believe in meritocracy. Ultimately, people make an organisation. The key is to engage in a two-way communication with them," he says. Perhaps that is one of the reasons why India's largest power transmission firm reported consolidated revenue of ₹10,447 crore in Q3FY22, up 3 per cent from ₹10,142 crore in the year-ago period. The PSU's consolidated net profit stood at ₹3,293 crore. And Sreekant is the winner in the Power category of the BT-PwC India's Best CEOs ranking.

Asked to describe himself, he recalls a management class he had attended. "We were asked to draw a picture which defined who we were. I drew a landscape with mountains and a river. I said the river is what I feel I am. I just go with the flow," he says. But people, he adds, think he is more like the mountain—resilient.

Sreekant is known to be one of the brightest minds

Key Highlights

- ➊ K. Sreekant, Chairman and Managing Director of Power Grid Corporation of India, is known to be an open, positive and practical boss
- ➋ In 2019, he was elevated to the post of CMD directly from Director (Finance)
- ➌ Power Grid reported consolidated revenue of ₹10,447 crore in Q3FY22, up 3 per cent from Q3FY21
- ➍ Analysts say Power Grid's dividend payout has been going up
- ➎ Sreekant will now focus on traditional transmission and expanding the data centre business, which Power Grid will go about with start-up-like fervour

PHOTO BY RAJWANT RAWAT